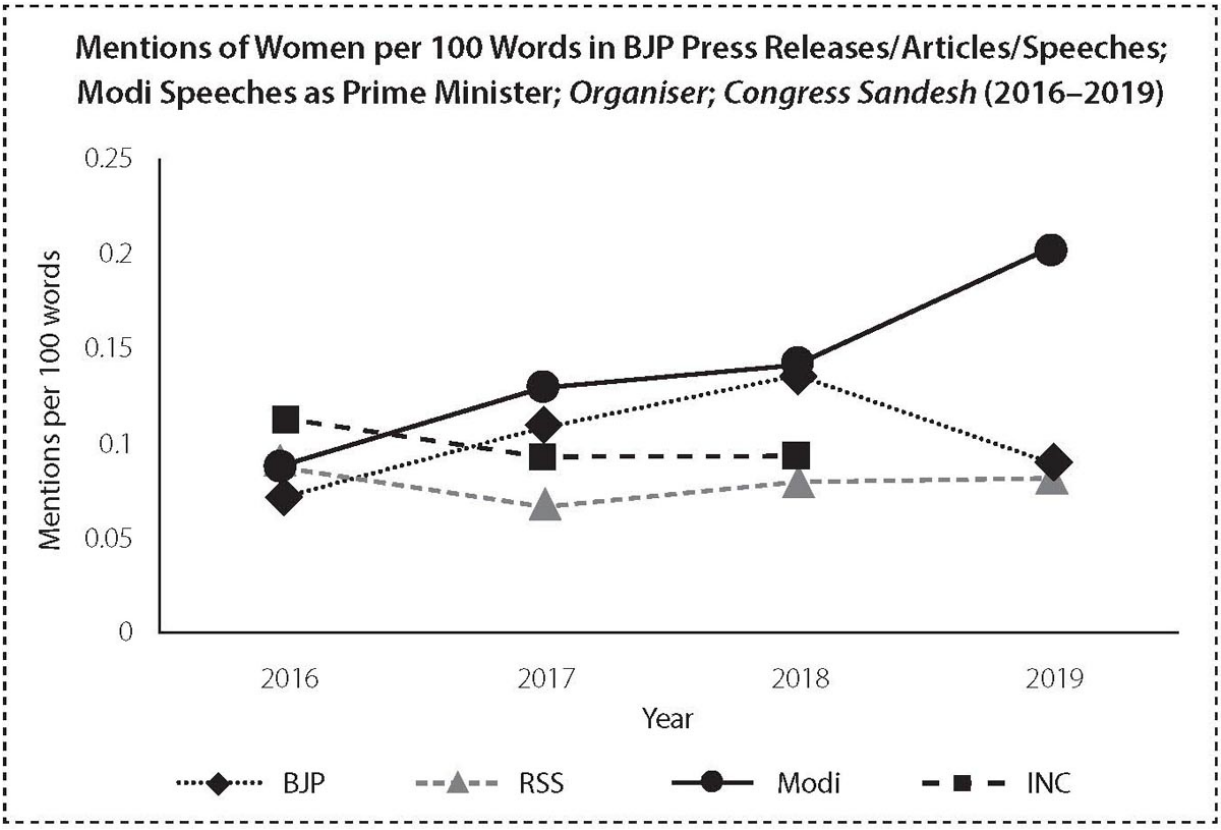
speeches with all BJP press releases and speeches and all articles in *Organiser* and *Congress Sandesh* in the 2016–2019 period. In 2016, the BJP, RSS and Modi all spoke about women in roughly similar volumes. Thereafter, the prime minister's focus on women skyrocketed (see Figure 17.6).

Figure 17.6: Modi Speaks about Women Much More than the BJP or the RSS



Source: Narad Index, Nalin Mehta and Rishabh Srivastava; for more details see Appendix 4/online on nalinmehta.in

A determined focus on women is clear in these charts. In his gender-focusing, Modi often harks back to women scholars in ancient India, linking them to various government developmental initiatives focused on women. As he said in *Mann ki Baat*,[69]

In our country, respect for women, their status in society and their contribution has proved to be awe inspiring to the entire world, since ancient times. There has been a long tradition of Vidushis … women